tidal

TECHGRIT WEBINAR · THURSDAY, OCTOBER 29, 2026

Cloud Migration in the AI Era: From Assumptions to Evidence

Agentic loops, rich context, and the new cost of modernization

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Founder & CEO, Tidal

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Host, TechGrit

HOW WE'LL SPEND THE NEXT 45 MINUTES

A conversation

OPEN

Intro

Jitu frames the question

FIRESIDE

From assumptions to evidence

What agentic loops change about the cost of modernization - and what they still can't do on their own

SHOW

Short demo

The same loop, with and without context

YOUR TURN

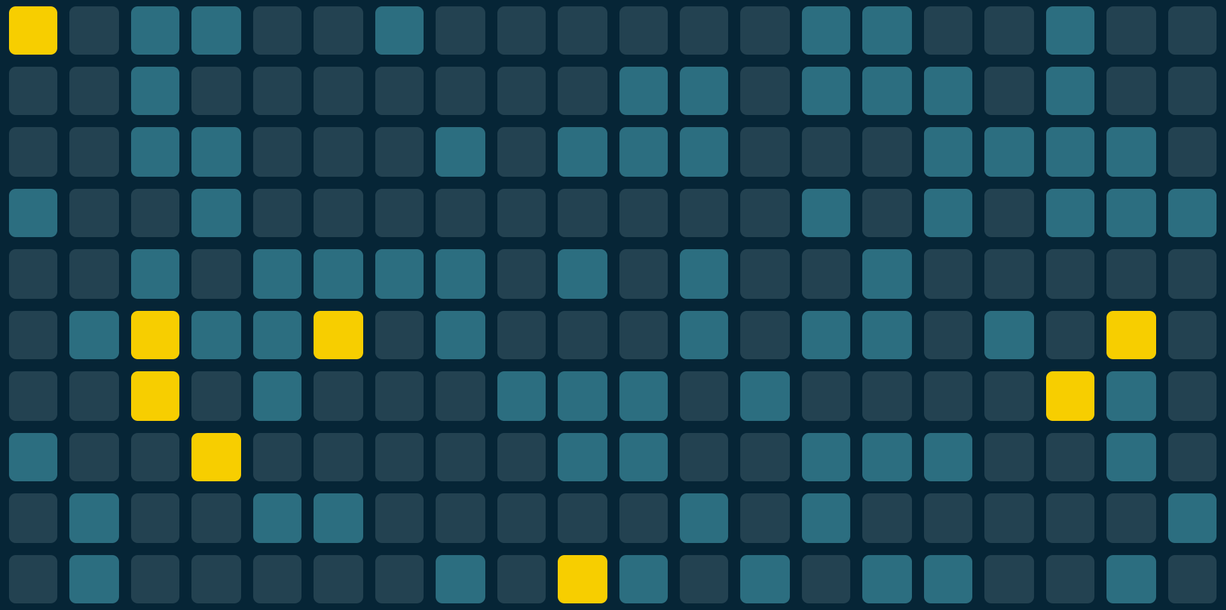
Live Q&A

Drop questions in the chat any time

You'll do some of the work tonight: there's a list we're going to build together.

BEAT 1 · THE OLD ASSUMPTION

"Modernization is expensive. So we lift and shift it, or leave it alone."



Left alone

Lifted and shifted

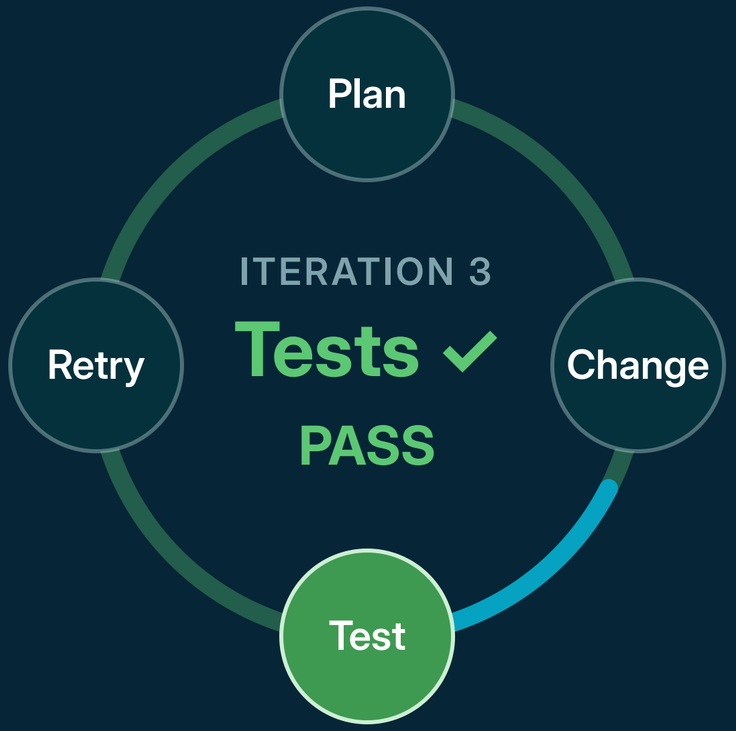
Properly modernized

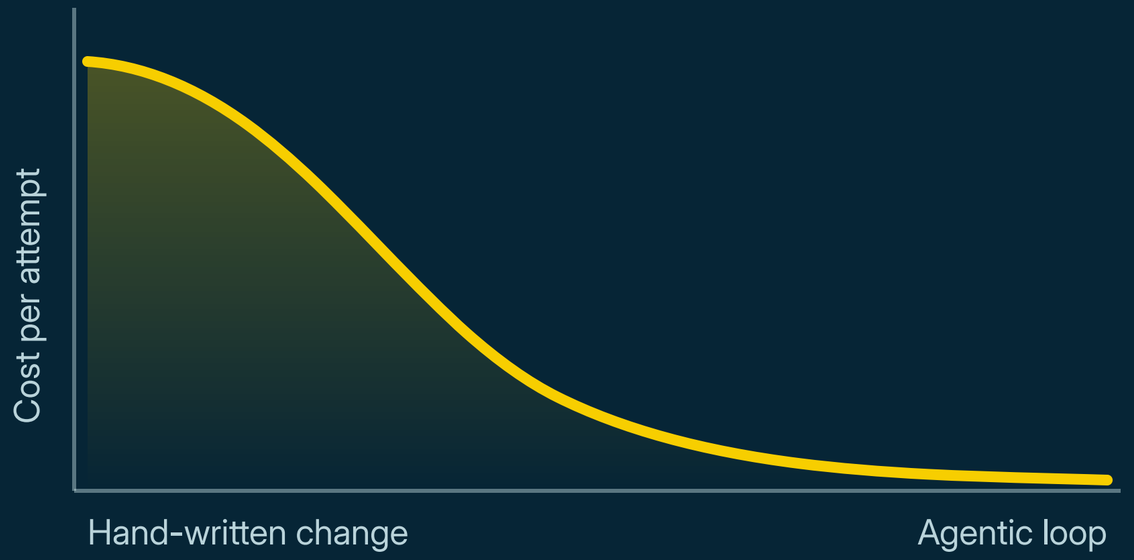
A typical-looking portfolio. Illustrative, not data.

? What does it cost to modernize one app properly?

BEAT 2 · BREAK THE MATH

An agent loop: plan, change, test, retry until it passes





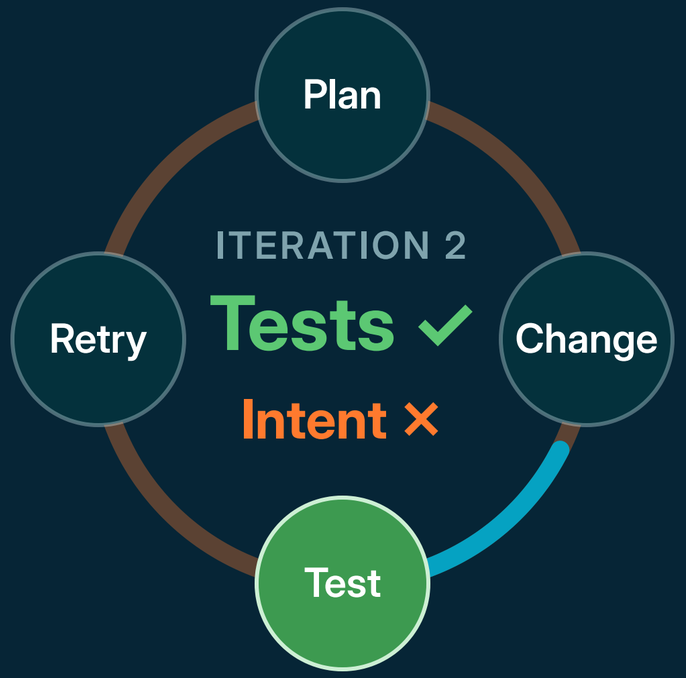
Each retry costs minutes, not sprints. The cost of execution is trending toward zero.

Illustrative trend, not measured data

? So... is every app affordable to modernize now?

BEAT 3 · THE TWIST

Same loop. No context. Confidently wrong.



- ✕ Rebuilt a module the business already planned to retire
- ✕ Dropped a nightly partner file feed the repo never mentions
- ✕ Optimized what's easy to measure, not what the owner cares about

Illustrative failure patterns

> **"Correct in shape but wrong in business intent."**
>
> David Colebatch, "The Architecture Question That Never Dies", tidalcloud.com blog

? **What does the agent need that the code doesn't contain?**

BEAT 4 · YOUR TURN - USE THE CHAT

What does the agent need that the code doesn't contain?

1. **Business intent**
   Why does this app exist?
2. **Owners**
   Who decides, who gets paged?
3. **Dependencies**
   What breaks if it moves?
4. **Data flows**
   Who reads and writes its data?
5. **Risk & compliance**
   What can't go wrong?
6. **What matters to the business**
   Value, criticality, cost of downtime
7. **What can be retired**
   Not everything deserves a loop

BEAT 5 · THE BOTTLENECK

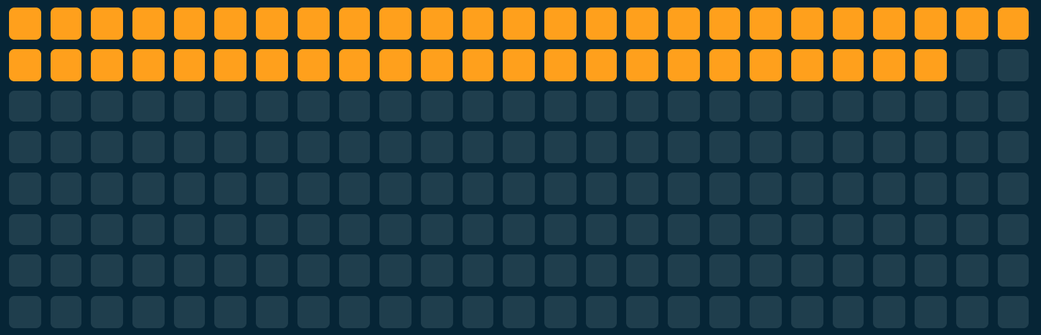
Now gather that list for 200 apps. By hand.

The change
agentic loop, per app



The context
interviews, workshops, spreadsheets





48 of 200 apps with context gathered · **Illustrative** portfolio, relative pace only

The scarce thing is no longer code. It's context.

"At enterprise scale, manual approaches break down because of duplicated evidence collection, inconsistent scoring, weak provenance, and the inability to maintain the assessment as evidence changes." - tidalcloud.com/enterprise-modernization

? Where does rich context come from, at portfolio scale?

BEAT 6 · YOUR LIST, ANSWERED

Context gathered at portfolio speed

tidal accelerator

1. Business intent ✓
2. Owners ✓
3. Dependencies ✓
4. Data flows ✓
5. Risk & compliance ✓
6. What matters to the business ✓
7. What can be retired ✓

Server & infrastructure discovery
Apps, servers, databases and data pipelines, grouped by application
→ dependencies · data flows

Source code & database analysis
Languages, frameworks, data stores and their constraints
→ dependencies · risk

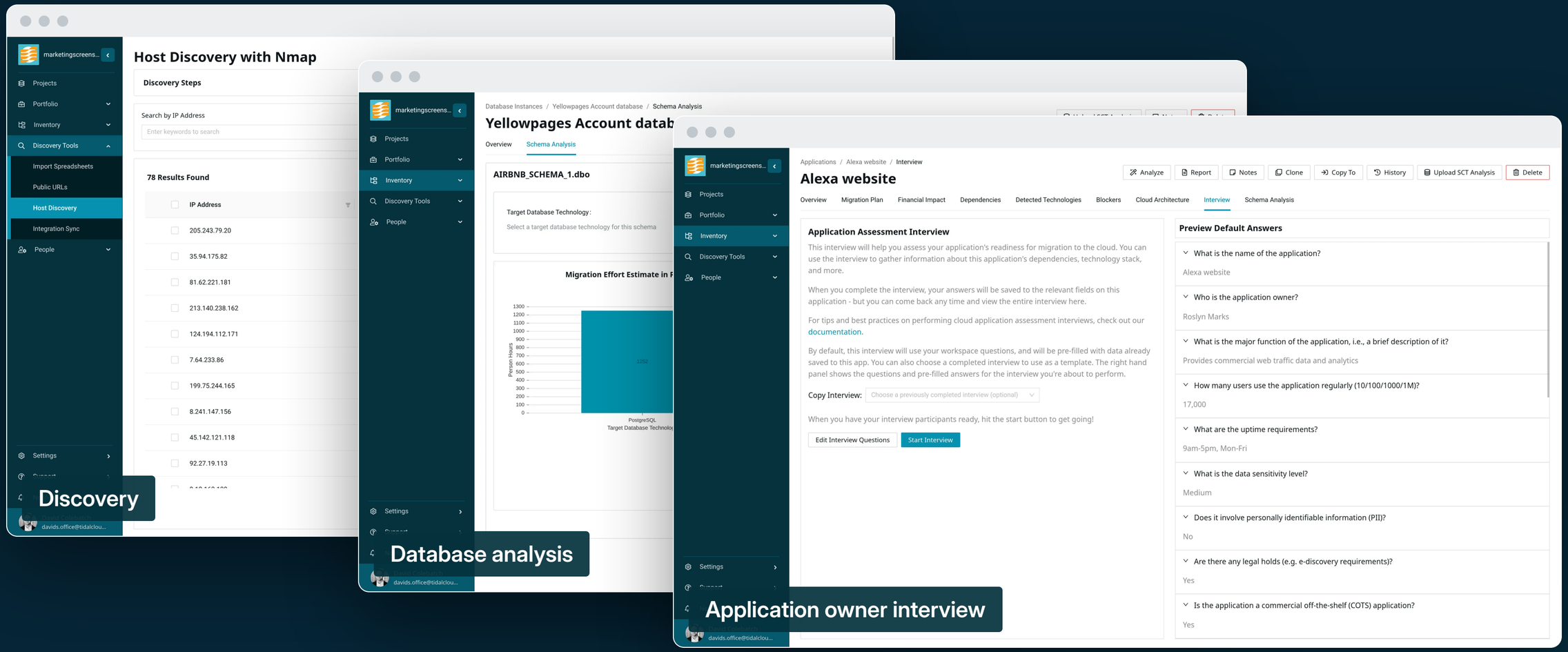
Business context capture
Application owner interviews: 20 ready-made, customizable questions
→ intent · owners · what matters · what can be retired · your additions

AI-assisted insights
Risk patterns and modernization candidates, grounded in evidence
→ risk · what can be retired

API, CLI and published agent skills
So your coding agents read the context before they loop

REAL CAPTURES · DEMO WORKSPACE

Evidence, not assumptions



FROM RECORD TO LOOP

Context your coding agents can actually read

Accelerator
application record and evidence

→

API + Tidal Tools CLI
typed, auditable access

→

Agent skill
public, open standard

→

Your coding agent
plans with context, then loops

```
# Public: github.com/tidalmigrations/agent-skills
$ npx skills add tidalmigrations/agent-skills --skill tidal-tools
$ tidal login
$ tidal analyze code
```

Works with Agent Skills-compatible tools such as Cursor, Claude Code and Kiro, per the repository README.

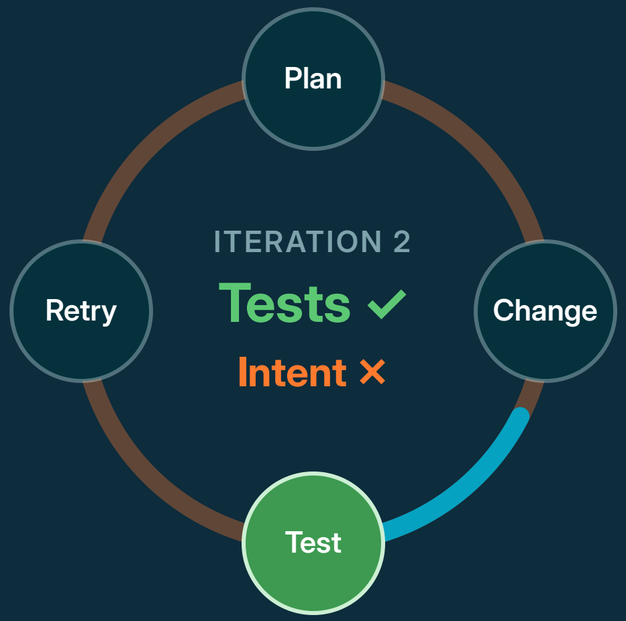
> **"Guardrails live below the agent."**
>
> David Colebatch, "The Architecture Question That Never Dies", tidalcloud.com blog

DEMO

The same loop, with and without context

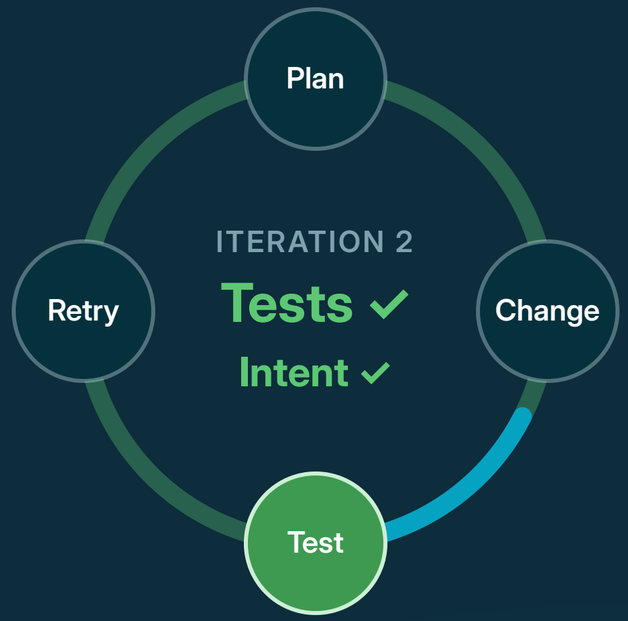
Raw code only

tests pass · intent missed



Code + portfolio context

tests pass · intent met

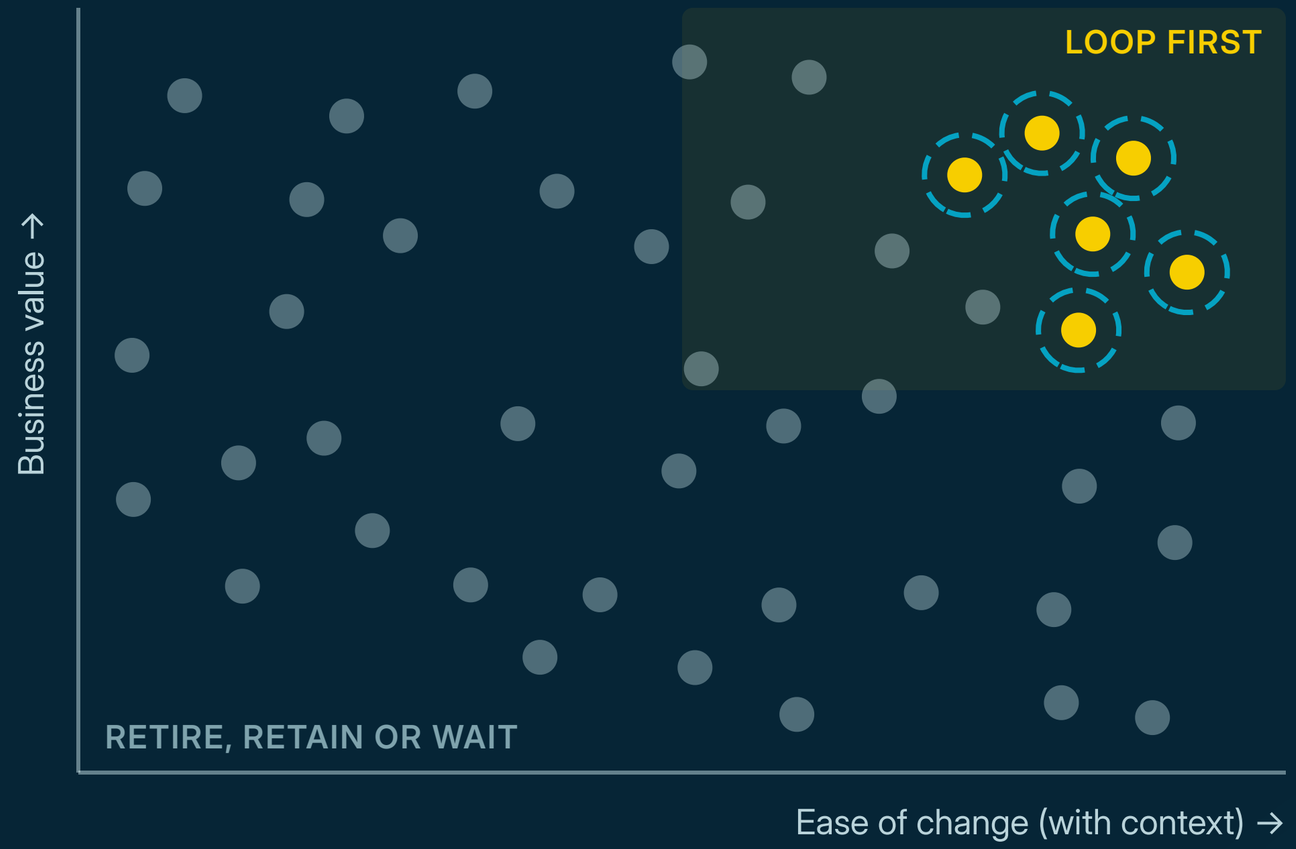


▶ LIVE DEMO · switch screen share to Accelerator

1 to 10 minutes

BEAT 7 · PORTFOLIO, NOT PRODUCT

With context, point the loops at the highest-value apps first



Context tells you which apps deserve a loop, which should be retired, and which can wait.

That's a portfolio decision - made before you spend on execution.

Illustrative portfolio

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

The cost of modernization is now set by the quality of your context.

FREE TO USE · THE EDUCATIONAL SPINE

Tidal Enterprise Modernization Methodology™

DISCOVER

Enterprise Intelligence

Evidence-backed context, not mere inventory

Portfolio discovery

Owner interviews, dependencies, code and data

DECIDE

Transformation Strategy

The right future for each app

Workload classification (6R)

Prioritization

Migration path definition

DELIVER

Measurable Business Outcomes

Not merely "apps moved"

Point loops at approved, high-value work

Return new evidence to the record



Reassess as conditions change - the methodology is a loop too.

tidalcloud.com/enterprise-modernization

LIVE Q&A

Your questions

Use the chat - Jitu will bring them in.

THANK YOU

Thank you to TechGrit and Jitu for hosting



David Colebatch

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Start with the methodology. It's free. The first step is always to understand your portfolio.